Subcontract Intake and Approval Workflow

Construction and procurement | Workflow specification and working prototype

INGRID KAO | INDEPENDENT PROJECT | SYNTHETIC DATA | NOVEMBER 11, 2026

Purpose: give each subcontract request a complete intake record, a defined reviewer, an auditable approval route, an ordered signature record and a usable weekly status report.

The package includes a working local workflow engine and an editable Excel register. USD thresholds and role assignments are illustrative policy choices, not company policy or delegated signing authority. Signature events are demonstration records, not electronic signatures.

1. Approval policy

Contract amount (USD)	Required sequential route
Up to and including $50,000	Legal -> Project Manager
More than $50,000 through $250,000	Legal -> Project Manager -> Finance
More than $250,000	Legal -> Project Manager -> Finance -> Executive
Any amount with nonstandard terms	Insert Senior Legal after Legal; then continue through the applicable amount route.

2. Decision rules

The requester identifies any departure from standard terms and provides an explanation. Legal confirms the issue and routes nonstandard terms to Senior Legal regardless of value. The engine enforces the configured sequence and rejects approval by the requester or an actor not assigned to the current role.

Contract value determines the approval route. It does not establish authority to sign. Changes to value, scope, risk allocation or the agreement version require review before relying on prior approvals. The prototype uses a new request for a revised commercial submission; it does not silently reuse an earlier approval.

3. Signature and release gates

Complete all required reviews and business approvals first. Confirm required guarantee and insurance references and dates. Record the subcontractor signature before the company authorized-signatory event. The second event sets the execution date. Hold prevents progression while a missing requirement remains unresolved.

Business ownership: Legal owns contract terms; the Project Manager confirms scope, schedule and budget need; Finance reviews financial exposure; the Executive approves the highest value tier. The authorized company signatory remains a distinct role.

Intake and Record Requirements

Fields are captured before routing, with conditional requirements where applicable.

Field or group	Requirement and validation
Request ID	Unique, nonblank record key. Duplicate IDs are rejected.
Project / subcontractor / scope	Required project name, legal counterparty name and description of work.
Requester ID	Required actor identifier; must not approve the same request.
Amount / currency	Positive amount with at most two decimals; USD only in this prototype.
Submitted timestamp	ISO timestamp with UTC timezone; retained for queue and cycle calculations.
Needed-by date	Date requested for completion; drives the overdue queue.
Planned start / contract expiry	Valid ISO dates; contract expiry cannot precede planned start.
Nonstandard terms / notes	Boolean risk flag; explanation required when true.
Guarantee required / reference / expiry	Required flag at intake. If required, reference and expiry must be complete before signing.
Insurance required / reference / expiry	Required flag at intake. If required, reference and expiry must be complete before signing.
Subcontractor signatory	Required counterparty signatory ID; company actor cannot sign for it.
Approval roles and results	System route plus each role decision, actor and timestamp. Not overwritten by a signature.
Status / current owner	Derived by the local engine; editable demonstration fields in the Excel register.
Hold or rejection reason	Required explanation; preserve the prior events and responsible actor.
Signature timestamps / execution date	Counterparty then company; execution date is populated only after the second event.
Audit events	Ordered events capture action, actor, timestamp and request ID.

Date and document controls

A populated expiry date alone does not establish adequate coverage. Legal must confirm required amounts, beneficiary, form, validity period and any extension obligations. Track contract expiry, guarantee expiry and insurance expiry separately; a guarantee can expire while a signed contract is still being performed.

The engine validates input and transition rules. The workbook supports review and reporting; its editable cells do not authenticate reviewers or enforce authority. Local JSON events are preserved by the CLI but remain editable on disk.

Lifecycle and Weekly Reporting

4. State controls

Stage	Required action / next owner
Intake	Validate and submit the complete request; route to Legal.
Legal Review	Legal reviews; Senior Legal follows if nonstandard terms are flagged.
Business Approval	Project Manager, then any required Finance and Executive approvals.
Ready for Signature	Required reviews complete; check documents; subcontractor signs first.
Counterparty Signed	Company authorized signatory records the second signature.
Executed	Execution date recorded; retain contract and monitor expiry dates.
Hold / Rejected	Hold records a correctable issue; Rejected ends the request. No signature bypass.

5. Weekly scorecard definitions

Measure	Definition
Week / as-of date	Monday through the selected as-of date; example as-of November 11, 2026.
Received / executed	Requests submitted in the reporting week; executions recorded in that week.
Open matters	All requests outside Executed and Rejected. Include Hold.
Overdue requests	Open request with needed-by date earlier than the as-of date.
Queue by stage and owner	Count open matters by current workflow stage and assigned owner.
Cycle time / aging	Excel uses execution date less submission date; the engine uses elapsed UTC days from timestamps. Open age uses the selected as-of date. Both are calendar-day measures, with the reporting grain labeled.
Guarantee alerts	Required missing/expired support and expiries within 30 days, including executed contracts still requiring monitoring.

The local engine generates CSV and Slack-ready text when the report command runs. Excel formulas refresh the report when inputs or the as-of date change. No scheduled Slack delivery or live Make connection is configured in this package.

Implementation and Acceptance Checks

6. Run the independent prototype

Open the Excel tracker first to review the ten synthetic requests, approval routes, date alerts and weekly totals. Follow START_HERE.md to seed a local practice database, enter a request, progress approvals and export a report. The engine requires Python 3 and uses only the standard library. Workbook and engine share the starting data; later edits do not synchronize automatically.

7. Make / Slack connection mapping

Connection step	Implementation requirement
Intake trigger	Form or webhook supplies the validated intake schema and a unique request ID. Reject incomplete submissions before notifying reviewers.
Register write	Create or update a single row by request ID; retries must not create duplicate requests. Preserve the submitted version.
Approval message	Send request ID, value, current role, due date and record link. Resolve an authenticated actor before accepting a decision.
Decision / signature webhook	Validate current state, authority and sequence. Store eSignature-provider envelope ID and event evidence in a live implementation.
Reminder / weekly schedule	Run date checks and the weekly aggregation in the chosen business timezone; send the generated report only to the configured channel.
Failure handling	Capture failed writes or notifications for retry; never mark an approval or signature complete merely because a message was sent.

8. Acceptance coverage

Tests exercise amount thresholds at $50,000 and $250,000, nonstandard-term routing, missing intake fields, requester self-approval, wrong-role and premature-signature attempts, document holds, ordered signatures and terminal states. Reporting checks use the same synthetic register as the workbook.

Reference checks as of November 11: two requests received in the week beginning November 9; one executed in that week; three overdue open requests; two guarantee expiries within 30 days and one missing required guarantee. These are prototype results, not business performance improvements.

9. Deployment boundary

Before production use, connect authenticated identities and delegated authority, restrict record access, store final document versions, connect an eSignature provider, protect the audit trail, set the business timezone and retention policy, and test retry and notification failures. These remain integration requirements rather than completed deployment work.